Introduction to Holy Scripture

Chapter One

Introduction

1.1. What is the Bible?

The word "Bible" comes from the Greek *ta biblia*, where originally it is a plural noun meaning "the Books." When this word was taken over into Latin, it became singular, the Bible. As a book, it is the work of God and His Spirit. But each group or collection of books contained therein was written by inspired human beings. For all the reasons why the Bible has commanded and still commands the interest of many across cultures, generations and ages, the primary fact remains that it is for Jews, Christians, and to a lesser extent Moslems, a collection of God's revelation, containing as it were God's self-communication to the world he created.

The Bible is a record of God's revelations and His relationship with human beings. In it, God reveals Himself through His actions in nature and in history. The Bible is one of the oldest books. Its oldest sections were written about 1500 years before Jesus was born. Its newest sections were written about 1900 years ago.

The Bible is one of the most widely translated and available books in the world, with billions of copies in print. But what is the Bible? The question arises because of considerable variety in the contents and arrangement in Bibles of different Christian traditions. However, almost all denominations/sects accept the two main parts: an "Old Testament" and a "New Testament." The Old Testament has four sections: the Pentateuch, Histories, Poetical and Wisdom; and the Prophets. The New Testament has twenty-seven books.

Hebrew Bible is divided into three subsections:

Torah(law), Prophets (Nevi'im), and Writings (Ketuvim) with depending on counting between twenty-four or thirty-nine books. The Christian "Old Testament" ends with Malachi, but the Hebrew Bible concludes with 2 Chronicles. How did the Bible come to have different authorized canons? And why do texts of different faith communities not agree? To answer this question fully requires a range of disciplines, including history, philology, archaeology, and comparative religion.

1.2. Writing Place of the Bible

The Holy Land, at times variously named Canaan, Israel, the Levant or Palestine, has changed hands many times and has often been the center of conflict. The archaeology of Palestine is complex, in that it reflects all eras of the region's long history.

Although the Israelites appear to have invaded Canaan around 1400 B.C., they left almost no archaeological footprint until about 1200 B.C. During Iron I (usually dated c. 1200–1000 B.C.) the nation of Israel began to take shape. Examples of what appears to be Israelite material culture, such as the "four-room house" and "collar-rim" pottery, appear in the archaeology of this time. Hundreds of villages in central Canaan dated to this period may be regarded as Israelite. The Philistines first appeared in Canaan at this time as a part of the migration of the "Sea Peoples," and examples of their material culture (such as a distinctive bi chrome pottery that is comparable to a type of Mycenaean Greek pottery) began to appear.

Inasmuch as the Biblical record indicates that Israel was in the land and contending with various other enemies long before the Philistines became a threat, the argument that the Philistines and Israelites emerged in Canaan at about the same time is erroneous. Indeed, the presence of "Israel" on the Merneptah Stele (c.1210 B.C.) strongly suggests that Israel was well established in the land prior to 1200 B.C., the beginning of the Iron I Age.

1.3. Writers of the Bible

a. Old Testament

Considering its nature it is possible to reflect the point that both God and humans are truly the authors of the Bible, because its authors are inspired by the Holy Spirit. God revealed to the forefathers, such as Noah, Abraham, Isaac, and etc. Through His revelation God commanded the fathers to obey to the commands; for example, God revealed to Abraham commended him to leave his birth place and go to the land where God would show him (Genesis, 12: 1-2). This revelation again came down to Moses the judge and the prophet, and he included it in the Torah. Moses was not only the writer of the revelation came to Abraham but also he was the one whom God told him how the universe was created.

With our present knowledge we cannot name all the inspired writers of the Bible. Some of them may never be known, for ancient authors seldom signed their books. According to

tradition, however, certain books are ascribed by to well-known Bible people. Modern scholars constantly study the books for evidences of their authorship.

Most inspired authors of the Old Testament books are Israelites/Jewish who were unconditionally given authorship gifts/grace; example, while Jeremiah was at child stage, the word of God came to him. He was not willing to convey the prophetic message from God to the Israelites. Jeremiah vehemently resisted the divine command not to be obeyed by telling a pretext that he was yet a child. However, God forced him saying: *before I formed you in the womb I knew you, before you were born I set you apart; I appointed you as a prophet to the nation* (Jeremiah, 1:5). Like Jeremiah, Samuel was called at his child stage to prophesy on Israelites and he was ministering God under Eli (Samuel, 3:11-15).

b. The New Testament

The Twenty-Seven New Testament books were written by about eleven inspired authors. The four gospels were written by Matthew, Mark, Luke and John, whereas the fourteen epistles by St. Paul. The other epistles were also written by James, Peter, John and Jude. Acts of Apostles and Revelation were authorised by Luke and John respectively. According the western point of view, the Epistle to Hebrews was not the writing of St. Paul; it is believed that it was written by unknown writer and was reserved in the name of St. Paul. However, the scholars of the EOTC strongly believe that this epistle was written by St. Paul himself.

1.4. The Writing Date of the Bible

a. Old Testament Books

The Old Testament books (Genesis) were begun to be written in 1446 BC and completed in 430 BC. According to the Jewish Canon, the 39 Old Testament books were written during a period of a thousand years (1,016). The Book of Malachi was the last one written in the 5th century BC.

b. New Testament Books

The New Testament books (Mark) were begun to be written in 5o AD and completed in 96 AD. According to the Canon of St. Athanasius, the 27 New Testament books were completed in AD. 96. The Book of John's Revelation was the last one written at the end of the 1st century AD.

According to the western context, the Gospel of Mark was written earlier than Matthew. The Biblical arrangement and the tradition of the EOTC, the Gospel of Matthew was written earlier than Mark's.

1.5. Biblical Languages

There are two original languages the Bible: Hebrew and Greek. The Old Testament was written in Hebrew except for four chapters Ezra, six Chapters Daniel and Jeremiah 10.10.These were written in Aramaic. The entire New Testament was written in Greek, the language commonly spoken and written throughout the Roman Empire in the first and second centuries AD. Aramaic is a Semitic language related to Hebrew somewhat as Italian is related to Spanish. Aramaic had become the everyday language of Palestine by the time of Jesus, who undoubtedly preached in Aramaic. His sayings and teachings were probably first recorded in this language, for a few traces Aramaic remain in the gospel (Mk. 5:41;15:34). Though Aramaic documents were doubtless used by the gospel writers, they recorded the story of Jesus' life in Greek.

The Bible is an eastern book and was written by eastern people. "The prophecy came not in old time by the will of man: but holy men of God spoke as they were moved by the Holy Ghost" (2 Peter 1:21). These "holy men" spoke three main languages, which are Hebrew, Aramaic and Greek.

The oldest language is probably Aramaic. It was not called that then, but many Aramaic speaking people today say that Aramaic as a language goes all the way back to Adam and Eve. They call it "the Mesopotamian language." The first mention of Aram, the youngest son of Shem, is in Genesis 10:22. The language that Aram spoke was transmitted down to Abraham.

Abraham left his home in Mesopotamia and travelled with his brother Nahor to Haran in Syria. The son of Nahor was also called Aram (Genesis 22:21). This land area in Syria became known as the land of the Aramaens, or Aram. Later, Abraham left Haran and crossed the Euphrates River and travelled to Canaan. His descendants were called Hebrews, a term derived from the Aramaic word *abar*, meaning "to cross over." Gradually, a unique dialect and script was developed called Hebrew. The Old Testament scriptures were written and compiled in this language. Throughout the centuries from Moses' time on, Hebrew was used as the Biblical language and was preserved very carefully by the scribes.

By the time of the New Testament in the first century, Aramaic was the commercial and business language throughout the Near East and Greek and Latin were also spoken by the people in the Roman Empire. Hebrew continued to be the language preserved in the Old Testament scriptures. The Gospels were most certainly written in Aramaic and most likely Paul's epistles were also. But as the gospel reached out in the first century from Jerusalem into Antioch of Syria and then on into Achaia and Macedonia, which were Greek-speaking areas, the scriptures were almost immediately translated into Greek. This is also why there are additions of Greek loan words in the Aramaic (words of Greek origin spelled in Aramaic letters) and also Aramaic loan words in the early Koine (Biblical) Greek.

In the fourth century, there was a split between the eastern and western churches. Basically, the eastern churches continued to use the Aramaic version of the New Testament called the *Peshitta* (which means "simple" or "straight") and the western churches used the Greek versions. The two languages of scriptures grew up together and each has valuable things to contribute to Biblical study.

This is a very brief overview of the development of the three languages, but as you can see, because of this history, it is important that we study all three if we want to understand the Bible. Aramaic and Hebrew are very closely related and because of that, there is a strong tie between the Old and New Testaments. Greek is the language through which we eventually got the King James Version and it is the language which has been and still is the most studied by scholars and Biblical students.

1.6. The History of Bible Translation

In the third century BC a king called Ptolemy the 2nd decided it would be a good idea to get the Hebrew Bible translated into Greek for 'the Jewish community resident outside their own land in the North African commercial and intellectual Hellenistic metropolis of Alexandria.' He, as the story goes, appointed seventy translators who were told to sit in separate booths and work alone, and at the end of the process all seventy miraculously produced identical translations of the Hebrew Bible. What a way to check for accuracy! This translation became known as the Septuagint, and is one of the most reliable texts of the Old Testament we have, along with the Masoretic Text (10th century AD), and the Dead Sea Scrolls (1st century BC). Sometimes the Dead Sea Scrolls line up with the Septuagint rather than the Masoretic text, showing that in places the Septuagint might possibly represent an earlier and more reliable

Hebrew reading than the Masoretic text, despite the latter's understandable authority in the Judeo-Christian world.

The main reason to be thankful for this translation is that it is the main text alluded to by the writers of the New Testament. By then Greek had established itself as the language of education in the Mediterranean region, despite Roman military dominance, and the use of Aramaic by Jews in the home and on the street, and the use of Hebrew in the synagogues. Why do I say 'alluded to' not 'quoted'? Because the New Testament writers, like Winnie the Pooh, often 'used' the Septuagint to mean what they wanted it to, not what it originally communicated in the Hebrew. They felt they had a divine calling to write, and in doing so were writing not just ordinary words, but Scripture. For instance, '... it is very common for NT writers to apply an OT passage that refers to YHWH (commonly rendered "LORD" in English Bibles) to Jesus. This arises from the theological conviction that it is entirely appropriate to do so since, granted Jesus' identity, what is predicated of God can be predicated no less of him.' The world had changed after both the resurrection of Jesus from the 8 dead, and destruction of the temple, and they had a message to share.

Chapter Two

The Structure of Old Testament Bible

2.1.1. Structure of OT

The Bible is a (*biblos*) a single book. It has two Testaments, better called covenants or agreements between God and His people. Those two parts of the Bible are inseparably related: The New Testament is in the Old concealed, and the Old in the New revealed. These sections form a meaningful and purposeful whole, as they convey the progressive unfolding of the theme of the Bible in the person of Christ.

a. The Law (Pentateuch)

They are five in number. These are Geneses, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers and Deuteronomy.

b. History

They are twelve books in number. These are Joshua, Judges, Ruth, Samuel first and second, Kings first and second, Chronicles first and second, Ezra, Nehemiah and Esther.

c. Poetry

They are five in numbers. These are Job, Psalm, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes and Songs of Songs.

d. Prophets

I. Major Prophets

They are divided into two: major and minor prophets. Major Prophets are four in number. These are Isaiah, Jeremiah with his Lamentation, Ezekiel and Daniel.

II. Minor Prophets

They are twelve in number. These are Hosea, Joel, Amos, Obadiah, Jonah, Micah, Nahum, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Haggai, Zechariah and Malachi.

2.2. New Testament

2.2.1. Structure of New Testament

I. The Gospels

They are four in number. They are Matthew, Mark, Luke and John.

II. History

The Act of Apostles' book is a single one that tells about the history of the early church.

III. Epistles

a. The Epistles of St. Paul

They are fourteen in number. These are Romans, Corinthians, Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, and Colossians, Thessalonians first and second, Timothy first and second, Titus and Philemon.

b. General Epistles

They are seven in number. These are James, Peter first and second, John first, second and third and Jude.

VI. Prophecy

The book of the prophecy is a single one that tells about the future events which will happen to the world,

2.3. *Apocrypha*

Up to the Reformation the Bible in common use was the Latin version originally made by Jerome, and known as the *Vulgate*. When, however, Reuchlin reintroduced the study of the Hebrew language, and Protestants began to read the Hebrew original of the Old Testament, the discovery was made that the *Vulgate* contained many more books than the Hebrew Bible. The name Apocrypha was accordingly given to those books which were found in the Vulgate but not in the Hebrew Bible. But how did the books get into the Vulgate? If they were not part of the original Hebrew, whence did Jerome obtain them? The answer to the question is simple. The Jews in the early centuries of the Christian era had two versions of the Old Testament, one the original Hebrew, which was used more particularly in Palestine, the other a Greek translation, called the Septuagint, which was originally made at Alexandria and used

by the Greek-speaking Jews of the Dispersion. The Greek Bible, like the *Vulgate*, contains the extra books, known as the Apocrypha (with the exception of IV Ezra), which are not found in the Hebrew, and it was from the Greek Bible that Jerome introduced them into his Latin translation. The Apocrypha therefore represents the difference between the contents of the Hebrew Bible and the Septuagint plus IV Ezra.

We must remember that up to the time of the Reformation (in the 16th century) the Apocrypha formed an integral part of the Christian Bible. It is true that many of the Christian Fathers drew a distinction between the Apocrypha and the rest of the Old Testament; but after the fifth century the distinction was almost universally forgotten, and for a thousand years the Apocrypha held a well-nigh/*nearly* unchallenged place in Holy Writ. The Council of Trent definitely decreed that it was of equal authority with the other books of the Bible, and this position is still maintained by Roman Catholics today. Even after the Reformation the Apocrypha still held a high place in the affections of a large number of Protestants, though it was assigned a subordinate position as compared with that of the other books of Scripture.

2.3.1. Old Testament Apocryphal Books

The Old Testament Apocryphal Books are classified as follows:

I. Historical Works

I Esdras, I. and II, Maccabees.

II. The Didactic/*moral* Works

The Wisdom of Solomon, the Book of Sirach (Ecclesiasticus)

III. Religious Romances

The Book of Tobit, the Book of Judith

IV. Prophetic or Apocalyptic Works

The Book of Baruch, IV. Ezra (sometimes called II. Esdras)

V. Additions to the Old Testament

The addition to the Book of Esther, the Prayer of Manasseh, the three additions to Daniel, the Song of the Three Holy Children, The Story of Susanna, The Story of Bel and the Dragon. Most of these additions might very properly be placed in the class of Religious Romances.

2.3.2. The Wider Apocrypha

In addition to the Apocrypha proper, there are many other Jewish writings, belonging practically to the same period, which have never claimed to be regarded as Scripture, though they were held in high value by large circles of Christians in early times.

The most important books of the wider Apocrypha may be classified as follows:

a. Historical

III and IV Maccabees, the latter, however, as will be explained, though purporting to be historical, is really a philosophical discourse. ,

b. Poetry

The Psalms of Solomon

c. Apocalyptic Literature

The Book of Enoch, the Book of the Secrets of Enoch, the Apocalypse of Baruch, the Assumption of Moses, the Book of Jubilees, the Ascension of Isaiah and the Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs.

I. The Book of Enoch

The Apocalypse which is known as the Book of Enoch is not a single book, but a library containing at least five volumes, written by different authors at different periods in the last two centuries of the pre-Christian era. It is not difficult to see why it was that a whole literature grew up around the name of Enoch.

II. The Apocalypse of Baruch

The Apocalypse of Baruch is also a comparatively recent discovery. We owe it to an Italian scholar, named Ceriani, who found a Syriac version of the book in the Milan Library and published a Latin translation of it in 1866. The Syriac version was translated from the Greek, which in its turn was derived from a Hebrew original, so that we only know the real Apocalypse at third hand.

III. The Assumption of Moses

This Apocalypse was also, like Baruch, discovered by Ceriani in the library of Milan in 1861. It exists only in a single Latin fragment, which is incomplete. The Latin version contains evidence which proves that it was made from a Greek original, which came itself from a Hebrew autograph.

IV. The Book of Jubilee

The Book of Jubilees was first published in modern times in the form of a German translation from the Ethiopic version by Dillmann in 185 1. A Latin version was also discovered by Ceriani in the Milan Library a little later, and printed for the first time in 1861.

V. The Ascension of Isaiah

This Apocalypse has been preserved in its entirety only in an Ethiopic version, though fragments are found both in Latin and Greek. It differs from any of the Apocalypses, which we have hitherto dealt with, in containing a large admixture of Christian elements.

VI. The Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs

The Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs is one of the most interesting of the documents which belong to this class of Jewish literature. It consists of twelve small pamphlets, which purport to contain the last utterances of the twelve sons of Jacob. Each of these men is represented as calling his children around him on his deathbed and giving them words of counsel and advice with regard to the conduct of life. In most cases the Patriarch recalls some of the leading incidents of his own career, and uses them as a text from which he draws lessons of warning or exhortation for his children. The Testament of Gad may be taken as an illustration of the method of the writer. Gad tells the story of his own enmity against Joseph. Joseph, according to the narrative, had carried to his father a tale that his brothers were killing the best of his flock and making a feast. This angered Gad, and made him often wish to kill Joseph. His plans, however, were frustrated by the action of Judah, who sold Joseph to the Ishmaelites.

2.3.3. Other Apocryphal Literature

There are three other books belonging to the wider Apocrypha which cannot be classed as Apocalyptic and must therefore be treated separately, III Maccabees, IV Maccabees, and the Psalms of Solomon.

2.3.4. The Third Book of Maccabees

The title bestowed upon this book is altogether a misnomer/*contradiction*. There is absolutely no reference to the Maccabees or the Maccabean age in it at all. How the book got its name is quite inexplicable. The only point which it has in common with the other books of Maccabees is that it tells the story of the faithfulness of the Jewish people in a time of persecution. Some scholars have tried to justify the title by supposing that it was intended originally to be a kind of introduction to the books which deal with the Maccabean rising, but there seems to be nothing in the book itself that at all substantiates this theory. The only plausible explanation is to suppose that the title is due to an accident in transmission, though it is quite impossible, of course, to discover how the accident happened.

2.3.5. The Fourth Book of Maccabees

The fourth book of Maccabees is quite unlike the other books which bear the same title. It makes no pretence to give a historical account of the Maccabean age. Its chief interest is in philosophy and religion; the historical elements (if such they can be called) are entirely secondary and subordinate, and are only introduced to illustrate and substantiate its philosophical principles. The book is really a sermon or homily intended to urge its hearers or readers to a life of fidelity to God and self-control.

2.3.6. The Psalms of Solomon

The Psalms of Solomon occupy the same place in Apocryphal literature as the Psalter does in the Old Testament, though it is clear, from the scantiness of the allusions to them in early times, that they never secured a wide circulation, nor won their way into the affection of the Christian Church. The collection consists of eighteen Psalms of varying length and value. They are written for the most part in imitation of the Old Testament Psalter, and often reproduce its language, though it must be admitted that some of them are not devoid of originality and forcefulness.

Chapter THREE

The Structure of New Testament Bible

2.3.7. The New Testament Apocrypha

There is a sense in which it can be said that the New Testament does not possess an Apocrypha. There is no well-defined collection of writings, like the Old Testament Apocrypha proper, which have been re- cognised at any time as Scripture by the general consent of the Church. The New Testament Apocryphal writings correspond more nearly to the wider Apocrypha of the Old Testament, and comprise a number of documents of very varying value, which claim to have originated from the Apostolic age, and some of which were held in high esteem by the Christian Church.

The reason why there is no New Testament Apocrypha in the technical sense of the word can easily be explained. The Old Testament Apocrypha is the result of the existence of two different Canons of the Old Testament, both of which won for them wide recognition. In the case of the New Testament this phenomenon does not exist. There have been, of course, different Canons in different sections of the Church.

The Ethiopic Canon, for instance, contains eight books which are not found in our New Testament. The Canon of the Greek Church omits the Book of Revelation, and includes some documents which are not recognised elsewhere. The Syrian Canon omitted four of the Catholic Epistles and the Apocalypse. The Muratorian Fragment (A.D. 170) did not include Hebrews, James, or II Peter, but recognised the Apocalypse of Peter. Individual Fathers too, in the third and fourth centuries, showed their own particular preferences by their acceptance or rejection of different books. But there never was a time, at least after the third century, when two rival Canons divided Christendom.

2.3.8. Non-Canonical Books used as Scripture by the Early Church

a. The First Epistle of Clement

That the first Epistle of Clement was used in public worship is clearly proved by two statements of Eusebius (330) in his Ecclesiastical History. The first statement is found in an excerpt from a letter of Dionysius of Corinth (160-180) to Soter, Bishop of Rome.

In reply to Soter, Dionysius says: "Today has been the Lord's Day, and we have read your Epistle. Whenever we read it, we shall have our minds stored with counsel, as we do when we read the letter which was written to us in former times by Clement "(Book iv). It was not only in Corinth, however, that this Epistle was used in worship, for in his second statement (Book iii. 16) Eusebius says: "This "This Epistle we know to have been publicly read for the common benefit in most of the churches both in former times and in our own day." The custom of using the Epistle in church seems to have continued for some time after Eusebius, for at the commencement of the fifth century Jerome tells us that "it was still read publicly in some places."

b. The Teaching of the Apostles

The Didache or Teaching of the Apostles was discovered in 1873 by Bryennius, an ecclesiastic of the Greek Church, in the Jerusalem Convent at Constantinople, and published ten years later. We have abundant evidence that the book held a very high place in the regard of the early Church. Clement of Alexandria quotes it as Scripture. It is mentioned in Athanasius' list of sacred writings, where it follows immediately after Judith and Tobit. In Eusebius' classification of the books which claimed recognition in the Canon, it is ranked in the class of "the rejected."

c. The Epistle of Barnabas

The high importance which was attached to the Epistle of Barnabas in early times is proved by the following facts: it is found in one of the earliest and most valuable MSS. of the New Testament—the Sinaitic—where it follows immediately after the Book of Revelation; Clement of Alexandria (200) frequently quotes it, and ascribes it to the Apostle Barnabas; Origen (250) describes it as the " Catholic Epistle of Barnabas," and cites it as Scripture.

d. The Shepherd of Hermas

No book outside the New Testament was more popular in the ancient Church than the Shepherd of Hermas. It is found in the famous Codex Sinaiticus at the close of the New Testament, and in several other MSS. besides. Irenaeus (180) quotes it as Scripture. Origen (250) regards it as "divinely inspired." Eusebius (330), though he refuses to recognise it as canonical, says that" it was publicly read in churches," and " deemed most necessary for those who have need of elementary instruction."

2.3.9. The Apocryphal Gospels

The Apocryphal Gospels, as we have seen, may be divided into three classes: (1) Those which possibly preserve elements of genuine tradition. (2) Heretical Gospels, i.e. Gospels in which the narrative has been pur- posely altered to suit the tenets of some heretical sect. (3) Legendary Gospels, which embroider the account of the beginning and end of Christ's life with fictitious stories.

I. The Gospel According to the Hebrews

The only Gospel which has any serious claim to be regarded as genuine and reliable is the Gospel according to the Hebrews. Unfortunately, however, we only possess a few fragments of it, culled from the writings of various Fathers of the Church. The most important and interesting of these are:

1. Two references to the Baptism of Jesus
2. An extract containing an account of the visit of the rich young man to Christ, which proceeds upon the lines of Matt. xix. 16-22, but adds the following words
3. A fragment recording the appearance of Jesus to James after the Resurrection
4. The following post - Resurrection utterance of Jesus
5. A few sayings of Jesus

II. Heretical Gospels

III. The Gospel According St. Peter

The most interesting of all the heretical Gospels is that ascribed to Peter, a large fragment of which was recently discovered by the French Archaeological Mission, in a tomb at Akmim (Pentapolis), in Upper Egypt, and published in 1892. The fragment, unfortunately, only covers the last scenes in the life of Christ. It begins with the trial before Pilate, and ends with the visit of the women to the empty tomb on Easter morning.

IV. Other Heretical Gospels

The Gospel of the Ebionites, The Gospel according to the Egyptians,

V. The Newly Discovered Sayings of Jesus

In 1897 a papyrus fragment was discovered, in the mounds of Oxyrhynchus, an Egyptian town on the edge of the Libyan desert 120 miles south of Cairo, containing seven or eight “Sayings of Jesus."

VI. The Legendary Gospels

We possess some twenty-two documents — most of them belonging to a late date—which expand certain parts of the history of Christ's life by the addition of legendary embellishments. They may be divided into three classes: (a) Those which deal with the history of Joseph and Mary before the birth of Jesus, {b) Those which deal with the infancy and boyhood of Jesus, {c) Those which relate to the history of Pilate.

a. The Gospel of the Virgin Birth
b. The Gospel of the Pseudo-Matthew
c. The Gospel of the Nativity of Mary
d. The History of Joseph the Carpenter
e. Assumption of Mary
f. The Gospels of the Boyhood Jesus
g. Gospels Related to Pilate
h. Gospel of Nicodemus

2.3.10. APOCRYPHAL ACTS, EPISTLES, ETC

a. Apocryphal Act
b. The Acts of Paul
c. The Acts of Thomas
d. The Acts of Andrew
e. The Acts of John
f. The Acts of Philip
g. The Acts of Peter and Paul

2.3.11. Apocryphal Epistles

a. The Correspondence between Jesus and Abgarus
b. The Epistle of Paul to the Laodiceans
c. The Correspondence between Paul and Seneca
d. The Apocalypse of Peter
e. The Apocalypse of Paul

2.3.12. *Pseudepigrapha*

In addition to the books commonly called Apocrypha there is a wide variety of other ancient literatures, both Jewish and Christian, to which the name *pseudepigrapha* is often applied.

Apocrypha, *pseudepigrapha* sectarian literature from the Qumran Caves, and a wide variety of other ancient writings provide helpful material for understanding the world of the New Testament and the early church. While not a par/*equivalence* with inspired Scripture, such writings merit examination.

Chapter FOUR

Canonization

3.1. Canonization of the Bible

Canonization is the process by which the Books of the Bible receive their final approval and acceptance by the church leaders. How did the Books of the Bible come to be accepted as part of the canon of the Scripture? How would one recognize an inspired book if he saw it? What are the characteristics which distinguish a divine declaration from a purely human one? Several criteria were involved in this recognition process. The people of God had to look for certain earmarks of divine authority.

3.2. The Principles Discovering the Canonicity

False books and false writings were not scarce. Their ever-present threat made it necessary for the people of God to carefully review their sacred collection. Sacred writings are two categories to be examined: books accepted by some believers, but not others; and writings once accepted but later questioned.

Manuscripts from both categories were examined by church councils to verify whether they should be part of the Bible.

3.3. Basic Criteria for Canonization

There are five basic criteria. These are Authoritative, Prophetic, Authentic, Dynamic and Accepted.

a. The Authority of the Bible

Each book in the bible bears the claim of divine authority. Often the explicit “thus says the Lord” is present. Sometimes the tone and exhortation reveal in divine origin. Always there is divine pronouncement. In the more didactic (teaching) literature there is divine pronouncement about what believers should be.

In the historical books the exhortations are more implied and the authoritative pronouncements are more what God has done in the history of his people. If a book lacked the authority of God, it was not considered canonical and was rejected from being included in the Bible.

Let us illustrate this principle of authority as it relates to the canon. The Books of the prophets were easily recognized by this principle of authority. The repeated “And the Lord said unto me,” or “The word of the Lord came to me,” is abundant evidence of their claim to divine authority.

b. The Prophetic Authority of the Book

Inspired books come only through spirit–moved men known as prophets (2Pet 1: 20, 21). The word of God is given to His people only through His prophets. Every biblical author had a prophetic gift or function, even if he was not a prophet by occupation (Heb 1:1). St. Paul argued in Galatians his teachings and writings should be accepted because he was an apostle, neither from men nor through man, through Jesus Christ and God the Father (Gal 1:1). His book (epistle) was to be accepted because it was apostolic-it was from God-appointed spokesman or prophet.

c. The Authenticity of a Book

Another hallmark of inspiration is authenticity. Any book with factual or doctrinal errors (judged by previous revelations) could not be inspired of God. God cannot lie; His word must be true and consistent. In view of this principle, the Bereans accepted Paul's teachings and searched the Scriptures to see whether or not what St. Paul taught them was really in occurred with God's revelation in the Old Testament (Acts 17:11). Simple agreement with previous revelation would not by itself make a teaching inspired. But contradiction of a previous revelation would clearly indicate that a teaching was not inspired.

d. The Dynamic Nature of the Book

The fourth test for canonicity was not as evident as some of the others. This was the life-transforming ability (dynamic) of the writing. "*The word of God is alive and powerful"* (Heb 4:12). As a result it can be used *"for teaching, for correction and for training in righteousness*" (2Tim 3:16,17). The Apostle Paul revealed that the life-transforming ability of inspired writings was involved in the acceptance of all scripture; 2Tim 3:16,17 indicates this. St. Paul wrote Timothy, *"the Holy scriptures…are able to make you wise unto salvation*" Elsewhere, Peter speaks of edifying and evangelizing power of the word (1Pet 1: 23; 2: 2).

e. The Acceptance of the Book

Ezra was the first one to canonize the Bible; The final trademark of an authoritative writing is its recognition by the people of God to whom it was initially given. God's word given through His prophet and with His truth must be recognized by His people. Later generation of believers sought to verify this fact. For if the book was received, collected and used as God's word by those to whom it was originally given, then its canonicity was established. Communication and transportation being what it was in ancient times, it sometimes, took much time and effort on the part of church fathers to determine this recognition. For this

reason the full and final recognition by the whole church of the 66 books of the canon took many, many centuries.

3.3. The History of Canonization of the Bible

Ezra was the first one to canonize the Holy Bible; he canonized the five Books of Moses. When they were finished by Moses, they were carefully deposited by the side of the Ark of the Covenant (Deut. xxxi. 24, 25, 26). "And it came to pass, when Moses had made an end of writing the words of this Law in a book, until they were finished, that Moses commanded the Levites which bore the ark of the covenant of the Lord, saying, take this book or the Law, and put it in the side of the ark of the covenant of the Lord your God, that it may be there for a witness against you."

All Scriptures are written with the inspiration of the spirit of God or are the breath of God. They are also described as Holy Books containing the word of God (*Fitehanegest article-2*). The Holy Books are breath of God or are written under the inspiration of the Spirit of God. St. Paul sates in 2Timothy 3:16 "*all Scriptures are God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness."* Saint Cyril of Alexandria also wrote that *"Holy Books are the breaths of God."* (Faith of Fathers 78:67). Hence, all that is written in the Scriptures is the absolute truth. Nothing can be added or deducted from it. It can neither be modified nor changed. It was written by Holy men guided by the Spirit of God (2Pet.1:20; Mat 5:18; Luke 16:17).

It is written that there were times when the Lord either revealed himself, made His voice heard or acted through the one that he willed and commanded "*Write down these Words"* (Exodus 34:27;Deut. 31:19; Isaiah 8:1).

Eighty-one are the Old Testament and New Testament Books which have been accepted as canonical books of the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahido Church. The 85th canon of the Apostolic Constitution read like this: To all you Clergymen and Laymen let the following books be venerable and sacred.

3.3.1. The Canon of Laodicea (A.D. 363)

Let neither private psalms nor any uncanonica books be read in church, but only the canonical ones of the New and Old Testament (Canon 59).

After listing the books of the Old Testament, the canon continues saying lists of the New Testament: four Gospels, according to Matthew, Mark, Luke, and John; the Acts of the Apostles, seven Catholic Epistles, namely, one of James, two of Peter, three of John, one of Jude; fourteen Epistles of Paul, one of James, two to the Corinthians, one to the Galatians,

one to the Ephesians, one to the Philippians, one to the Colossians, two to the Thessalonians, one to the Hebrews, two to Timothy, one to Titus, and one to Philemon (Canon 60).

3.3.2. The Canon of Athanasius (A.D. 367)

Again (after a list of the Old Testament books) it is not tedious to speak of the books of the New Testament. These are, the four Gospels, according to Matthew, Mark, Luke, and John. After these, the Acts of the Apostles and Epistles called Catholic, of the seven apostles: of James, One; of Peter, two; of John, three; after these, one of Jude. In addition, there are fourteen Epistles of Paul the apostle, written in this order: the first, to the Romans; then, two to the Corinthians; after these, to the Galatians; next, to the Ephesians; then, to the Philippians; then, to the Colossians; after these, two of the Thessalonians; and that to the Hebrews; and again, two to Timothy; one to Titus; and lastly, that to Philemon and the Revelation of John. These are fountains of Salvation that who thirsts may be satisfied with the living words they contain. In these alone the teaching of godliness is proclaimed: *Let no one add to these; let nothing be taken away from them*.

3.3.3. The Canon of Gregory of Nazianzus (A.D. 329-89)

This canon, included among Gregory's poems (I, xii. 5 ff.), was ratified by the Trullan Synod in 692. It is in iambic verse, the lineation of which (but not the rhythm) is preserved, so far as possible, in the translation. Only the New Testament part is given here. [List to books of the Old Testament….]. But now count also [the books] of the New mystery; Matthew indeed wrote for the Hebrews the wonderful works of Christ, and mark for Italy, Luke for Greece, John, the great preacher, for all, walking in heaven. The Acts of the Holy apostles, the fourteen Epistles of St. Paul, seven universal Epistles; these are James, one and two of Peter, three of John and that of Jude's single epistle. If there is any besides these, it is not among the genuine books.

3.3.4. The Canon of the Third Synod of Carthage (A.D. 397)

The first council that accepted the present canon of the books of the New Testament was the Synod of Hippo in North Africa (A.D. 393); the acts of this council, however, are lost. A brief summary of the acts was read at and accepted by the Synod of Carthage, A.D. 397. Besides the canonical Scriptures, nothing shall be read in church under the name of divine Scriptures (Canon-24). Moreover, the canonical Scriptures are these: (then follows a list of Old Testament books). The books of the New Testament: the Gospels, four books, the Acts of the Apostles, one book; the Epistles of Paul, thirteen, of the same to the Hebrews one Epistle, of Peter, two of John, apostle, three; of James, one: of Jude, one; the Revelation of John. On the anniversaries of martyrs, their acts shall also be read.

3.4. Other Church Fathers, Scholars, and Historians Contributed to the Canonization of the Holy Scriptures

a. Clement (1st Century C.E.): the third bishop of Rome and author of a letter (1 Clement) written to the church at Corinth about 95 C.E.

b. Ignatius (35-107 C.E.): Bishop of Antioch in Syria and author of letters to several churches; Ephesians, Magnasians, Trallians, Romans, Philadelphians, Smyrneans. He also wrote a letter to Polycarp, bishop of Smyrna,

c. Muratorian Canon: The oldest extant list of New Testament writings, discovered in the 18th Century by L.A. Muratori in an 8th Century manuscript. The list generally thought to date from the 2nd Century.

d. Tatian (2nd Century C.E.): A native of Assyria, Tatian was a Christian apologist and author of the Diatessaron, a history of the life of Christ compiled from the four gospels and used in the Syriac church until the 5th Century C.E.):

e. Irenaeus (Ca. 130-200 C.E.): Bishop of Lyon, Gaul (France). Around AD 185, Irenaeus claimed that there were exactly four Gospels, no more and no less, as a touchstone/*criterion* of orthodoxy. He argued that it was illogical to reject Acts of the Apostles but accept the Gospel of Luke, as both were from the same author. In Against Heresies, he ridiculed those who think they are wiser than the Apostles because they were still under Jewish influence. This was crucial to refuting Marcion's anti-Judaizing, as Acts gibes/*jeers* honour to James, Peter, John and Paul alike. At the time, Jewish Christians tended to honour James (a prominent Christian in Jerusalem described in the New Testament as an apostle and pillar, and by Eusebius and other church historians as the first Bishop of Jerusalem) but not Paul, while Pauline Christianity tended to honor Paul more than James.

f. Eusebius of Caesarea (CA. 260-340 C.E.): His Ecclesiastical History, a multivolume history of the church down to ca. 300, was published ca. 325 C.E.

g. Constantine (CA. 274-337 C.E.): Roman emperor whose policy was to unite the Christian church to the secular State by the closest possible ties. His laws and letters are a chief primary source for the relations of Christianity and the State from 313 onwards.

h. Council of Nicaea (325 C.E.): The first ecumenical council of the Christian church called by Emperor Constantine who feared that disputes within the church would cause disorder in the empire. The Nicene Creed was formulated with its canons.

3.5. The Importance of the Canon for the Bible

So long as the living voice of prophets and apostles was to be heard, there was no pressing need of a canon of Scripture. Under the inspiration of God they knew what was inspired, and

what was not. But as soon as these men were dead—and with them inspiration to these particular people ceased—it became necessary that their writings be gathered together to know what their messages to the churches were, and to preserve those writings from corruption.

Another reason why a canon was necessary was to preclude/*prevent* the possibility of additions to the number of inspired works. Already numerous writings were extant purporting to be inspired. Hence the question arose, Which of these are really inspired? What is the extent of inspired literature?

Still another and potent reason for the formation of the canon lay in the fact that the Emperor Diocletian issued in A.D. 302 an edict that all the sacred books should be destroyed by fire. Hence the question arose as to which books rightly deserved the name of inspired and sacred.

3.6. OLD Testament Canon.

The formation of the Old Testament canon was gradual, and was composed of the writings which spread over many centuries. The approximate time line for the formation of the OT canon is 1600-1400 years. Moses commanded that the books of the law be placed in the ark (Deuteronomy 31:9, 26, Cf. 2 Kings 22:8 Joshua 24:26; 2 Samuel 10:25.)

Then were gathered and placed in the temple the historical and prophetical books from Joshua to David's time. On the construction of the temple Solomon deposited in it the earlier books (2Kings 22:3, Isaiah 34:16), and enriched the collection with inspired writings from his own pen, and also some prophetic writings. So we find Daniel (9:2 R.V.) referring to "the books," Isaiah to "The book of the Lord" (29:18, 34: 16).

After Solomon's day a succession of prophets arose, Jonah, Amos, Isaiah, Hosea, Joel, Micah, Nahum, Zephaniah, Jeremiah, Obadiah, and Habakkuk. These all flourished before the destruction of the temple, and enlarged the collection of existing sacred books by valuable additions.

After the Babylonian capture, when the temple was rebuilt and worship re-established, then doubtless were added the writings of Haggai and Zechariah. About fifty years after the temple was rebuilt Ezra made a collection of the sacred writings (Neh. 8:2,3,14). To this collection were added the writings of Nehemiah, Malachi, and Ezra. It is a fact of history that Nehemiah gathered the "Acts of the kings and the Prophets, and those of David," when founding a library for the second temple, 432 B.C. (See 2 Maccabees 2:13).

The canon of the Old Testament in the form we now have it, was the work of Ezra and the Great Synagogue. This fact is borne witness to in the most ancient Jewish writings. The Great Synagogue was composed of Ezra, Nehemiah, Haggai, Zechariah, and Malachi. There

is no doubt but that such a collection of books existed in the time of our Lord and the apostles (Luke 24:27, 44).

3.7. The New Testament Canon

The persecution of Diocletian (302 A.D.) brought to the front the question of the sacred literature of the church. The persecutors demanded that the Scriptures should be given up. This Christians refused to do. Hence the question became urgent-what books are apostolic? The answer lies in our New Testament. There were at that time many false and spurious gospels and epistles. Careful, prayerful, and deliberate examination, however, proved which were genuine and which were false. The genuine were received by the church as the inspired writings of the apostles and others whose names the books bear. Thus arose the New Testament canon.

There is much evidence to indicate that the Canon of the Old Testament was fixed by about the year 400 B.C. largely as a result of the work of Ezra and Nehemiah and a council of Jews known as the *Great Synagogue*, which met after the return from the Babylonian captivity. Long before that time, however, many of the books we now have in the Old Testament had been agreed upon as inspired. In the case of the New Testament, the fixing of the Canon was done mainly at the council at Carthage in 387 A.D., although the evidence points to the selection of the books as early as about the year 100A.D.

3.8. The Biblical Canon of the Ethiopian Orthodox *Tewahdo* Church

One Church which occupies a unique position in this regard is the Ethiopian Orthodox *Tewahdo* Church. Currently, it is the only Church whose Bible is comprised of 81 Books in total, 46 in the Old Testament, and 35 in the New Testament. It is also the biggest Bible, according to the number of books: Protestant Bibles usually contain 66 books, Roman Catholic Bibles 73, and Eastern Orthodox Bibles have around 76 books, sometimes more, sometimes less, depending on their belonging to the Greek Orthodox, Slavonic Orthodox, or Georgian Orthodox Church.

And although the Ethiopian Orthodox Church belongs to the group of Oriental Orthodox Churches which are in communion with each other, there is no common consensus among them as to which books make up the Biblical canon; for example, the Coptic Orthodox Church has the same canon as Western Protestant Churches, with the addition of the two Epistles of Clement in the New Testament (a total of 68 books).

3.8.1. The Bible in the Ethiopian Orthodox *Tewahdo* Church

As mentioned above, the Bible of the Ethiopian Orthodox Church consists of 81 books, 46 in the Old Testament, and 35 in the new.4 With this, the Ethiopian Orthodox Church has the

most extensive collection of Biblical books considered to be canonical of all the major Christian denominations.5 The number of books as well as the exact titles are laid down in the *Feteha Negest* (Law of the Kings), a book of law used in Christian Ethiopia since at least the 16th century, based on an Arabic manuscript written by a Christian Egyptian in 1238, which lists the books of the Bible. In Section 2, it states the number is to be 81; the actual titles of the books are mentioned in the text as well as in "Reading and Explanation of the *Feteha Negest*" (a kind of commentary).

It should not come as a surprise that most of the "additional" books (those not accepted by all or most other Churches) are books that either have been considered canonical Scripture by one or more of the other Churches at some point, and/or are summarized as Apocrypha or *Pseudepigrapha* by them today, meaning that they constitute the books about which there always has been a certain amount of discussion as to whether they actually should be considered as canonical or not. However, some of the books that we find in the Ethiopian Biblical canon do not fulfil these criteria, either, but are completely unique to that particular Church.

Yet another curious thing is that, although the number of books in the Ethiopian Orthodox Bible is always 81, this number is most commonly reached in two different ways (although other ways did and do exist).

Furthermore, there is currently no distinction at all between the book that are referred to as proto-canonical and deuteron-canonical. Whereas the Ethiopian Orthodox Church understand and uses these terms when referring to the respective books in, for example, the Catholic or Eastern Orthodox Church, or in the ancient writing, like the Festal Letter of St. Athanasius (see below), it does not differentiate in its own Bible between proto and deutero-canon. All books accepted into the Bible are considered equally inspired, equally the Word of God, and equally instructive.

A. Books of the Old Testament

In the official rendering, the number of the Old Testament books in the Ethiopian Orthodox Church is 46, divided into four sections. Those books include:

I. Books of Law (the 5 Books of Moses)

Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers and Deuteronomy.

II. Books of History

Joshua, Judges, Ruth, 1st and 2nd Samuel, 1st and 2nd Kings, 1st and 2nd Chronicles (2nd Chronicles includes the Prayer of Manasseh), Ezra and Nehemiah, Ezra Sutuel and 2nd Ezra, Tobit, Judith, Esther, 1st Meqabeyan

2nd and 3rd Meqabeyan, Joseph Ben Guriyon, Jubilees and Enoch.

III. Books of Psalms (Songs) and Wisdom

Job, Psalms, Proverbs, Reproof ("Tsegats" in Ge'ez), Ecclesiastes, Song of Songs, Wisdom (of Solomon) and Sirach.

IV. Books of Prophecy

Isaiah, Jeremiah (including Lamentations, the Remainder of Jeremiah, and Baruch), Ezekiel, Daniel (including Susannah, the Prayer of the Three Children, and Bel and the Dragon), Hosea, Amos, Micah, Joel, Obadiah, Jonah o Nahum, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Haggai, Zechariah and Malachi.

As mentioned above, this is the official rendering. In the actual Bible which is currently on the market, the arrangement is somewhat different: 1st and 2nd Samuel have been printed as individual books in it, similarly 1st and 2nd Kings, 1st and 2nd Chronicles, and 2nd and 3rd Meqabeyan. Also, Ezra and Nehemiah have been separated, as have Ezra Sutuel and 2nd Ezra. All the writings of Jeremiah, which are one book in the official rendering, have been separated in the actual printing: Jeremiah, Baruch, Lamentations, and the Remainder of Jeremiah; there is also a book titled "the Remainder of Baruch". The book of Joseph Ben Guriyon has been eliminated. In the actual print version, therefore, the number of Old Testament books is 54. The order also varies; in the print version it is: Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy, Joshua, Judges, Ruth, 1st and 2nd Samuel, 1st and 2nd Kings, 1st and 2nd Chronicles, Jubilees, Enoch, Ezra, Nehemiah, Ezra Sutuel, 2nd Ezra, Tobit, Judith, Esther, 1st Meqabeyan, 2nd Meqabeyan, 3rd Meqabeyan, Job, Psalms, Proverbs, Reproof, Wisdom, Ecclesiastes, Song of Songs, Sirach, Isaiah, Jeremiah, Baruch, Lamentations, Remainder of Jeremiah, Remainder of Baruch, Ezekiel, Daniel, Hosea, Amos, Micah, Joel, Obadiah, Jonah, Nahum, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Haggai, Zechariah, and Malachi.

B. Books of the New Testament

As for the New Testament, the Ethiopian Orthodox Church receives the following books into its canon (in that order).

I.Gospels

Gospel of Matthew, Gospel of Mark, Gospel of Luke and Gospel of John.

II.History

Acts (of the Apostles)

III. Epistles of Paul

Romans, 1st Corinthians, 2nd Corinthians, Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians, 1st Thessalonians, 2nd Thessalonians, 1st Timothy, 2nd Timothy, Tito, Philemon and Hebrews.

IV. Other Epistles

1st Peter, 2nd Peter, 1st John, 2nd John, 3rd John, James (called "Yaqob" in Ge'ez) and ude.

V. Prophecy

Revelation of John

VI. Books of Church Order

1. The Order of Zion,
2. Commandments (Te'ezaz),
3. Abtils,
4. "Gitzew",
5. 1st Book of Covenant,
6. 2nd Book of Covenant,
7. Clement and
8. Didascalia.

Except for the books of Church Order, the canon agrees mostly with that received by other Churches. As we see, in this official rendering, the number of books is 35, making a total of 81 with the 46 books of the Old Testament. In the actual printing, however, the 8 books of Church Order are not printed (as they are generally not widely available), so that in the printed version, the number of New Testament books is 27, making again a total of 81 with the actual 54 books of the Old Testament. How the Ethiopian Orthodox *Tewahdo* Church came to accept those 81 books, and which ancient canons played in a role in that decision will be the topic of the next few sections.

3.8.2. The Comparison of Symbolical Canons with the Canons of the Church Fathers

85 Apostolic Canons	Council of Laodicea	Council(s) of Carthage	St.Athanasius	St.Gregory Nazianzen	Amphilochius of Iconium
Genesis	Genesis	Genesis	Genesis	Genesis	Genesis
Exodus	Exodus	Exodus	Exodus	Exodus	Exodus
Leviticus	Leviticus	Leviticus	Leviticus	Leviticus	Leviticus
Numbers	Numbers	Numbers	Numbers	Numbers	Numbers
Deuteronomy	Deuteronomy	Deuteronomy	Deuteronomy	Deuteronomy	Deuteronomy
Joshua	Joshua	Joshua	Joshua	Joshua	Joshua
Judges	Judges	Judges	Judges	Judges	Judges
Ruth	Ruth	Ruth	Ruth	Ruth	Ruth
1st Kings	1st Kings	1st Kings	1st Kings	1st Kings	1st Kings
2nd Kings	2nd Kings	2nd Kings	2nd Kings	2nd Kings	2nd Kings
3rd Kings	3rd Kings	3rd Kings	3rd Kings	3rd Kings	3rd Kings
4th Kings	4th Kings	4th Kings	4th Kings	4th Kings	4th Kings
1st Chron.	1st Chron.	1st Chron.	1st Chron.	1st Chron.	1st Chron.
2nd Chron.	2ndChron.	2nd Chron.	2nd Chron.	2nd Chron.	2nd Chron.
1st Ezra	1st Ezra	1st Ezra	1st Ezra	1st Ezra	1st Ezra
2nd Ezra (Nehemiah	2nd Ezra Nehemiah	2nd Ezra Nehemiah	2nd Ezra Nehemiah	2nd Ezra Nehemiah	2nd Ezra Nehemiah)
Esther	Esther	Esther	Esther	……	Esther
……	……	Judith	Judith	……	……
……		Tobit	Tobit	……	……
1st Meqa	…….	1st Meqa	……	……	……
2nd Meqa.	……	2nd Meqa.	……	……	……
3rd Meqa.	…….	……	……	……	……
Psalms	Psalms	Psalms	Psalms	Psalms	Psalms
Job	Job	Job	Job	Job	Job
Proverbs	Proverbs	Proverbs	Proverbs	Proverbs	Proverbs
Sirach	……	……	Sirach	……	……
Hosea	Hosea	Hosea	Hosea	Hosea	Hosea
Amos	Amos	Amos	Amos	Amos	Amos
Micah	Micah	Micah	Micah	Micah	Micah
Joel	Joel	Joel	Joel	Joel	Joel
Obadiah	Obadiah	Obadiah	Obadiah	Obadiah	Obadiah
Jonah	Jonah	Jonah	Jonah	Jonah	Jonah
Nahum	Nahum	Nahum	Nahum	Nahum	Nahum
Habakkuk	Habakkuk	Habakkuk	Habakkuk	Habakkuk	Habakkuk
Zephaniah	Zephaniah	Zephaniah	Zephaniah	Zephaniah	Zephaniah
Haggai	Haggai	Haggai	Haggai	Haggai	Haggai
Zechariah	Zechariah	Zechariah	Zechariah	Zechariah	Zechariah
Malachi	Malachi	Malachi	Malachi	Malachi	Malachi
Isaiah	Isaiah	Isaiah	Isaiah	Isaiah	Isaiah
Jeremiah	Jeremiah	Jeremiah	Jeremiah	Jeremiah	Jeremiah
……	Baruch	……	Baruch	……	……
……	Lamentations	……	Lamentations	……	.....
……	Epistle Jer.	……	Epistle Jer.	……..	…….
Ezekiel	Ezekiel	Ezekiel	Ezekiel	Ezekiel	Ezekiel
Daniel	Daniel	Daniel	Daniel	Daniel	Daniel

42	**41**	**43**	**45**	**37**	**38**
The comparison of the New Testament Books shows					
85 Apostolic Canons	**Council of Laodicea**	**Council(s) of Carthage**	**St. Athanasius**	**St. Gregory Nazianzen**	**Amphilochius of Iconium**
M a t t h e w	M a t t h e w	M a t t h e w	M a t t h e w	M a t t h e w	M a t t h e w
Mark	Mark	Mark	Mark	Mark	Mark
Luke	Luke	Luke	Luke	Luke	Luke
John	John	John	John	John	John
Acts	Acts	Acts	Acts	Acts	Acts
Romans	Romans	Romans	Romans	Romans	Romans
1st Corin.	1st Corin.	1st Corin.	1st Corin.	1st Corin.	1st Corin.
2nd Corin.	2nd Corin.	2ndCorin.	2nd Corin.	2nd Corin.	2nd Corin.
Galatians	Galatians	Galatians	Galatians	Galatians	Galatians
Ephesians	Ephesians	Ephesians	Ephesians	Ephesians	Ephesians
Colossians	Colossians	Colossians	Colossians	Colossians	Colossians
1st Thess.	1st Thess.	1st Thess.	1st Thess.	1st Thess.	1st Thess.
2nd Thess.	2nd Thess.	2nd Thess.	2nd Thess.	2nd Thess.	2nd Thess.
1st Timothy	1st Timothy	1st Timothy	1st Timothy	1st Timothy	1st Timothy
2nd Timothy	2nd Timothy	2nd Timothy	2nd Timothy	2nd Timothy	2nd Timothy
Tito	Tito	Tito	Tito	Tito	Tito
Hebrews	Hebrews	Hebrews	Hebrews	Hebrews	Hebrews
James	James	James	James	James	James
1st Peter	1st Peter	1st Peter	1st Peter	1st Peter	1st Peter
2nd Peter	2nd Peter	2nd Peter	2nd Peter	2nd Peter	2nd Peter
1st John	1st John	1st John	1st John	1st John	1st John
2nd John	2nd John	2nd John	2nd John	2nd John	2nd John
3rd John	3rd John	3rd John	3rd John	3rd John	3rd John
……..	……	Apocalypsi	Apocalypsis	……..	Apocalypsis
2nd Epis. Cl.	…….	……	……	……	……
2nd Epis. Cl.	……	……	……	……	……
1st Clemen	……	……	……	……	……
2nd Clement	……	……	……	……	……
3nd Clement	……	……	……	……	……
4nd Clement	……	……	……	……	……
5nd Clement	……	……	……	……	……
6nd Clement	……	……	……	……	……
7nd Clement	……	……	……	……	……
8nd Clement	……	……	……	……	……
36	26	27	27	26	27
Total=78	**Total=67**	**Total=70**	**Total=72**	**Total=63**	**Total=65**